

Word family: **action / actions / active / actively / activity / activate / activation**

Base word: action

Plural: actions

Related forms: active, actively, activity, activate, activation

Useful expressions / extensions: take action, in action, put into action, course of action, action plan, legal action

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / adjective, adverb, and verb family (相關形容詞、副詞及動詞)

Your sentence:

> “She is the kind of person who shows love through small **actions** rather than big speeches.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **actions** means **the things a person actually does—their concrete behaviour—rather than what they merely say**.

In your passage, your grandmother expresses care through practical behaviour such as:

- > making tea
- > cutting fruit
- > looking after everyone

So **small actions** means **small but meaningful acts of care**.

繁體中文： ** **一個人實際做出的行為或舉動；這裡指透過細微而具體的照顧行為來表達關愛**

中文翻譯：

> “She is the kind of person who shows love through small actions rather than big speeches.”

「她是那種會透過細微的**實際行動 / 舉動**來表達關愛，而不是靠大篇幅說話的人。」

Here:

small actions = 細微但實際、能表達關心和愛意的行為

1. **action = something a person does (行為 / 舉動) — 行動；行為**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She shows love through small **actions**.”

「她透過細微的**行動 / 舉動**來表達愛。」

Practice 2

> “His **actions** showed that he cared.”

「他的**行為**顯示他很在乎。」

Practice 3

> “Kind **actions** can have a big effect.”

「善意的**行動**可以帶來很大的影響。」

action = 一個人實際做出的事情、舉動或行為

2. **actions** = behaviour in practice (實際行為) — 行為；所作所為

A very important broader use.

Practice 4

> “You are responsible for your **actions**.”

「你要為自己的**行為 / 所作所為**負責。」

Practice 5

> “Her **actions** were more important than her words.”

「她的**實際行為**比她說的話更重要。」

actions = 一個人實際做過的事情，尤其用來判斷其態度、責任或品格

This is especially close to your original sentence.

3. **action** vs words (行動與言語) — 行動；實際表現

A highly useful contrast.

Practice 6

> “His words sounded kind, but his **actions** were different.”

「他的話聽起來很友善，但他的**實際行為**卻不同。」

Practice 7

> “She believes that **actions** matter more than promises.”

「她相信**實際行動**比承諾更重要。」

action = 與說話、承諾或意圖相對的實際行為

This is the exact conceptual contrast in your passage:

> **small actions**

> rather than

> **big speeches**

4. **take action** (採取行動) — 採取措施；行動起來

A major fixed expression.

Practice 8

> “We need to **take action** immediately.”

「我們需要立即**採取行動**。」

Practice 9

> “The company took **action** to improve safety.”

「公司**採取措施**改善安全。」

take action = 不再只是討論，而是開始做具體事情以處理問題或達成目標

5. **take action against** + person/problem (採取對付措施) — 採取行動對付 / 處理

Practice 10

> “The school took **action against** repeated bullying.”

「學校針對重複出現的欺凌**採取了處理措施**。」

Practice 11

> “The authorities may take **action against** the company.”

「當局可能會對公司**採取行動**。」

take action against = 對某個人、機構或問題採取正式處理、限制或懲處措施

6. **action** = process of doing something (行動 / 實施) — 行動 ; 執行

Practice 12

> “The plan requires immediate **action**.”

「這個計劃需要立即**執行 / 採取行動**。」

Practice 13

> “Discussion is useful, but we also need **action**.”

「討論固然有用，但我們也需要**實際行動**。」

action = 把想法、計劃或決定實際做出來的過程

7. **put something into action** (付諸行動) — 實行 ; 付諸實踐

Practice 14

> “It is time to **put the plan into action**.”

「是時候把計劃**付諸實行**了。」

Practice 15

> “She quickly **put her ideas into action**.”

「她很快便把自己的想法**付諸實踐**。」

****put something into action = 把原本只是計劃、想法或決定的東西真正開始實行****

8. ****action plan (行動計劃) — 行動方案 ; 執行計劃****

A common compound.

Practice 16

> “The team created an ****action plan****.”

「團隊制定了一份****行動計劃****。」

Practice 17

> “The report includes a detailed ****action plan****.”

「報告包括一份詳細的****執行方案****。」

****action plan = 為達成目標而列出的具體步驟、責任和時間安排****

9. ****course of action (處理方法 / 行動方案) — 行動方針****

A major fixed expression.

Practice 18

> “We need to choose the best ****course of action****.”

「我們需要選擇最佳的****行動方案 / 處理方法****。」

Practice 19

> “The doctor recommended a different ****course of action****.”

「醫生建議採取另一種****處理方案****。」

****course of action = 為應對某個情況而選擇的一套行動或做法****

10. ****action = movement / activity happening (動作 / 活動) — 動作 ; 活動****

Practice 20

> “The camera captured the **action**.”

「鏡頭捕捉了整個**動作 / 活動場面**。」

Practice 21

> “There was a lot of **action** in the city centre.”

「市中心有很多**活動 / 動靜**。」

action = 正在發生的動作、活動或事件

This is more dynamic than the “individual act” sense.

11. **in action** = operating / being used (運作中) — 運作中；實際使用中

A very useful expression.

Practice 22

> “I want to see the machine **in action**.”

「我想看看這部機器**實際運作時的情況**。」

Practice 23

> “The new system looks impressive **in action**.”

「新系統**實際運作起來**看起來很不錯。」

in action = 正在實際運作、使用或執行中

12. **action** = exciting events in a film/story (動作場面) — 動作；刺激場面

A major media meaning.

Practice 24

> “The film has plenty of **action**.”

「這部電影有很多**動作場面**。」

Practice 25

> “The second half of the movie is full of **action**.”

「電影後半段充滿**刺激的動作場面**。」

****action = 電影、小說或遊戲中快速、刺激、充滿衝突或冒險的事件****

13. ****action film/movie (動作片) — 動作電影****

Practice 26

> “He enjoys watching **action films**.”

「他喜歡看**動作片**。」

Practice 27

> “The actor became famous for **action movies**.”

「那位演員因出演**動作電影**而成名。」

****action film = 以追逐、打鬥、冒險等刺激事件為主要內容的電影****

14. ****action = military fighting / combat (軍事行動) — 戰鬥；軍事行動****

A formal and established sense.

Practice 28

> “The soldiers were killed in **action**.”

「那些士兵在**戰鬥中**陣亡。」

Practice 29

> “The unit saw **action** overseas.”

「該部隊在海外曾參與**實戰 / 軍事行動**。」

****action = 軍事衝突中的實際戰鬥或作戰活動****

Common expression:

> ****killed in action****

> = 戰死 / 在作戰中陣亡

15. ****action = legal process (法律行動) — 訴訟 ; 法律行動****

A major legal meaning.

Practice 30

> “The company faces legal ****action****.”

「這家公司面臨****法律行動 / 訴訟****。」

Practice 31

> “She decided to take legal ****action****.”

「她決定採取****法律行動****。」

****legal action = 透過法院或法律程序提出申索、追究責任或尋求救濟****

16. ****action = official/disciplinary measure (正式處分 / 措施) — 行動 ; 處分****

Practice 32

> “The school may take disciplinary ****action****.”

「學校可能採取****紀律處分****。」

Practice 33

> “No further ****action**** will be taken.”

「不會再採取任何進一步****措施****。」

****action = 機構或當局為處理某個問題而採取的正式措施****

17. **action = effect/mechanism of something (作用 / 機制) — 作用 ; 運作方式**

A scientific/technical sense.

Practice 34

> “The drug blocks the **action** of a particular enzyme.”

「這種藥物會阻止某種酵素的**作用**。」

Practice 35

> “The cleaning **action** of the product removes grease.”

「這款產品的清潔**作用**可以去除油脂。」

action = 某種物質、機器或力量產生效果的方式 / 機制

Common in:

- * medicine
- * chemistry
- * mechanics
- * product descriptions

18. **action of a machine/mechanism (機械動作 / 機制) — 動作機制 ; 運作**

Practice 36

> “The smooth **action** of the mechanism makes it easy to use.”

「這個機械裝置**運作順暢**，所以很容易使用。」

Practice 37

> “The lever has a simple **action**.”

「這個槓桿的**運作機制**很簡單。」

action = 機械部件移動或運作的方式

19. **action = effect of natural forces (自然作用) — 作用**

Practice 38

> “The rocks were shaped by the **action** of water.”

「岩石受到水的**作用**而形成這種形狀。」

Practice 39

> “Wind **action** gradually changed the landscape.”

「風的**作用**逐漸改變了地貌。」

****action = 自然力量對物質或環境產生的持續影響****

20. **action = decision/measure in business or administration (措施) — 措施；處理**

Practice 40

> “Management promised corrective **action**.”

「管理層承諾採取**糾正措施**。」

Practice 41

> “Immediate **action** was required.”

「需要立即採取**處理措施**。」

****action = 為解決問題、改善情況或執行政策而採取的具體措施****

21. **corrective action — 糾正措施**

A common business/compliance compound.

Practice 42

> “The company introduced **corrective action** after the audit.”

「公司在審核後採取了**糾正措施**。」

Practice 43

> “Managers must document any **corrective action**.”

「經理必須記錄所有**糾正措施**。」

corrective action = 為修正錯誤、問題或不合規情況而採取的正式措施

22. **collective action** — 集體行動

A useful social/business expression.

Practice 44

> “The problem requires **collective action**.”

「這個問題需要**集體行動**。」

Practice 45

> “Workers organized **collective action**.”

「工人組織了**集體行動**。」

collective action = 一群人共同協調並採取的行動，以達成共同目標

23. **active** = physically engaged / doing things (活躍的) — 活躍的；積極活動的

The main adjective family member.

Practice 46

> “She remains very **active** for her age.”

「以她的年紀來說，她仍然非常**活躍**。」

Practice 47

> “The children are physically **active** every day.”

「孩子們每天都有很多**身體活動**。」

****active = 經常活動、參與事情或處於運作狀態的****

24. ****active = participating / involved (積極參與的) — 積極的 ; 活躍參與的****

Practice 48

> “She is an ****active member**** of the community.”

「她是社區一位****積極參與的成員****。」

Practice 49

> “He plays an ****active role**** in the project.”

「他在項目中扮演****積極而重要的角色****。」

****active = 主動參與某項活動、組織或事情，而不是被動旁觀****

25. ****active = currently operating / in use (有效 / 運作中的) — 啟用中的 ; 有效的****

Practice 50

> “Your account is still ****active****.”

「你的帳戶仍然****有效 / 啟用中****。」

Practice 51

> “The system has several ****active users****.”

「這個系統有多名****活躍使用者****。」

****active = 目前仍在使用、運作、生效或參與中的****

26. ****active = producing an effect (活性的) — 活性的 ; 有效成分的****

A technical/scientific branch.

Practice 52

> “This is the **active ingredient** in the medicine.”

「這是藥物中的**活性成分 / 有效成分**。」

Practice 53

> “The chemical remains **active** for several hours.”

「這種化學物質可以保持**活性**數小時。」

active = 能夠產生特定化學、生物或藥理作用的

27. **activity** = something people do (活動) — 活動

Practice 54

> “Walking is a healthy **activity**.”

「步行是一項健康的**活動**。」

Practice 55

> “The centre organizes activities for older people.”

「中心為年長人士安排各種**活動**。」

activity = 人們進行的事情、運動、任務或娛樂活動

28. **activity** = amount of action happening (活動量 / 動靜) — 活動 ; 動態

Practice 56

> “There was unusual **activity** outside the building.”

「建築物外有異常的**活動 / 動靜**。」

Practice 57

> “Business **activity** increased this month.”

「本月商業**活動**有所增加。」

****activity = 某個地方、領域或系統中正在進行事情的程度****

29. ****activate = make something start working (啟動) — 啟動 ; 啟用****

Practice 58

> “Press the button to ****activate**** the system.”

「按下按鈕以****啟動系統****。」

Practice 59

> “The alarm is ****activated**** automatically.”

「警報系統會自動****啟動****。」

****activate = 使機器、系統、功能或程序開始運作 / 生效****

30. ****activate = cause biological/chemical process to begin (激活) — 活化 ; 啟動****

Practice 60

> “The protein ****activates**** a cellular response.”

「這種蛋白質會****啟動 / 激活細胞反應****。」

Practice 61

> “Heat ****activates**** the chemical.”

「熱力會****活化****這種化學物質。」

****activate = 令某種生物、化學或物理機制開始產生作用****

31. ****activation = act/process of activating (啟動 / 啟用) — 啟動 ; 激活****

Practice 62

> “Account ****activation**** takes only a few minutes.”

「帳戶**啟用**只需幾分鐘。」

Practice 63

> “Muscle **activation** increased during the exercise.”

「運動期間的肌肉**激活程度**有所提升。」

****activation = 令系統、功能、機制或生物過程開始運作的過程****

Important distinction: **action vs activity**

**action**

often means:

> one specific act or something done to achieve a result.

> “Her action helped him.”

**activity**

often means:

> an organized thing people do, or ongoing movement/work.

> “The school organized an activity.”

So:

****action = 行動 / 行為****

****activity = 活動 / 活動狀態****

Important distinction: **action vs behaviour**

**action**

usually refers to:

> a specific thing someone does.

****behaviour****

describes:

> the broader way someone acts over time or in a situation.

For example:

> “That action was kind.”

= 那個行動很善良。

> “Her behaviour is always kind.”

= 她一向的行為都很友善。

Your grandmother's tea-and-fruit routine consists of individual ****actions****, while together they form a pattern of ****behaviour****.

Important distinction: ****action vs act****

These overlap substantially.

****an act****

often means one specific deed:

> “an act of kindness”

****an action****

can mean a specific deed but also:

- * steps taken
- * official measures
- * legal proceedings
- * dynamic activity
- * mechanical effect

So ****action**** has a broader range.

Important distinction: **action vs movement**

movement

focuses on physical change of position.

action

can mean movement, but often emphasizes purposeful behaviour or dynamic activity.

> “His arm movement was slow.”

= 手臂移動很慢。

> “His quick action prevented an accident.”

= 他迅速採取行動，避免了事故。

Important distinction: **action vs reaction**

action

= something done or a force/effect produced.

reaction

= response to something that happened first.

> action → reaction

For example:

> “Her action surprised him.”

> “His reaction was immediate.”

Important distinction: **actions vs words**

This is central to your sentence.

words

= what someone says.

actions

= what someone actually does.

Someone can say:

> “I care about you.”

But their **actions**—such as preparing food, helping, visiting, or listening—may demonstrate that care more concretely.

Your passage deliberately emphasizes:

> **small actions rather than big speeches**

Important distinction: **take action vs do an action**

take action

is a natural fixed expression meaning:

> begin doing something concrete about a situation.

> “We need to take action.”

do an action

is possible in some technical contexts, but is not the normal everyday equivalent.

For learners:

> **take action** 

> **do action**  in ordinary usage

Important distinction: **action vs measure**

action

is broad.

measure

usually means:

> a specific step introduced to achieve or prevent something.

> “safety measures”

When institutions respond to a problem, both may occur:

> “The company took action.”

> “The company introduced new safety measures.”

Important distinction: **active vs action**

action

= noun

> “We need action.”

「我們需要行動。」

active

= adjective

> “She is very active.”

「她很活躍。」

They belong to the same practical family but are not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **active vs proactive**

active

means:

> participating, moving, operating, or doing things.

proactive

specifically means:

> taking action in advance rather than waiting for a problem to happen.

Someone can be active without necessarily being proactive.

Important distinction: **activity vs action**

A simple learner contrast:

> **an activity**

can be something enjoyable or organized:

> “painting is a relaxing activity”

while:

> **action**

often suggests a response or purposeful step:

> “we must take action.”

Important distinction: **in action vs take action**

in action

= actually operating or performing

> “See the machine in action.”

take action

= start doing something concrete

> “We need to take action.”

Same noun, very different expression.

Family-extension note

Following the same curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **action** family:

* **action** — act/behaviour = 行動 / 行為
* **actions** — conduct = 所作所為
* **actions vs words** = 行動與言語
* **take action** = 採取行動
* **take action against** = 採取措施對付 / 處理
* **put into action** = 付諸實行
* **action plan** = 行動計劃
* **course of action** = 行動方案
* **in action** = 實際運作中
* **action** — dynamic activity = 動作 / 活動
* **action** — film = 動作場面
* **action film** = 動作片
* **action** — military = 戰鬥 / 軍事行動
* **legal action** = 法律行動 / 訴訟
* **disciplinary action** = 紀律處分
* **action** — mechanism/effect = 作用 / 運作方式
* **corrective action** = 糾正措施
* **collective action** = 集體行動
* **active** — energetic = 活躍的
* **active** — participating = 積極參與的
* **active** — operating = 啟用 / 生效中的
* **active ingredient** = 活性 / 有效成分
* **activity** = 活動 / 活動狀態
* **activate** = 啟動 / 激活
* **activation** = 啟動 / 激活過程

As demonstrated in the reference, practical compounds, grammatical constructions, and related forms should be included when they add genuine learning value, while still distinguishing them from the core meanings of bare **action**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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action — something done	一個人實際做出的事情、舉動或行為
actions — conduct	一個人實際做過的事情，尤其用來判斷其態度、責任或品格

actions vs words	與言語、承諾或意圖相對的實際行為	
take action	開始做具體事情以處理問題或達成目標	
take action against	對某個人、機構或問題採取正式處理 / 限制措施	
action — implementation	把想法、計劃或決定實際執行的過程	
put into action	把原本只是想法或計劃的內容真正開始實行	
action plan	為達成目標而列出的具體步驟、責任和時間安排	
course of action	為應對某情況而選擇的一套行動或做法	
action — movement/activity	正在發生的動作、活動或事件	
in action	正在實際運作、使用或執行中	
action — film/story	電影、小說或遊戲中刺激快速的動作、冒險或衝突場面	
action — military	軍事衝突中的實際戰鬥或作戰活動	
legal action	透過法院或法律程序追究責任 / 尋求救濟	
disciplinary action	機構針對違規或問題採取的正式紀律措施	
action — effect/mechanism	某種物質、機器或力量產生效果的方式或作用	
corrective action	為修正錯誤、問題或不合規情況而採取的正式措施	
collective action	一群人共同協調並採取的行動	
active — energetic	經常活動、參與事情或保持活力的	
active — involved	主動參與某項事情，而不是被動旁觀的	
active — operating	目前仍在使用、運作或生效中的	
active — chemical/medical	能產生特定化學、生物或藥理作用的	
activity — thing done	人們進行的任務、運動、娛樂或其他活動	
activity — level of happening	某個地方、領域或系統中事情正在發生的程度	
activate	使系統、功能或機制開始運作 / 生效	
activation	令系統、功能或生物機制開始運作的過程	

For your original sentence

> “She is the kind of person who shows love through small ****actions**** rather than big speeches.”

The exact meaning is:

****actions = 一個人實際做出的具體行為和舉動****

Therefore:

> ****small actions****

= ****「細微但實際、能表達關心和愛意的行為」****

In your passage, examples include:

- > making tea
- > cutting fruit
- > looking after everyone

So the sentence creates a clear contrast:

> **actions** = what she actually does

versus:

> **speeches** = what someone says

The key idea is that her affection is shown through **practical behaviour** rather than verbal declarations.